

How your standing works

Everything that decides your badge — and how to move up. Nothing here is punitive; it's built so good work compounds and a bad day doesn't define you.

Everyone starts equal

Every manufacturer joins at the **Verified** badge with the standard platform fee. Your badge is never assigned by hand and never starts low as a penalty — you earn your way up from the same line as everyone else.

Four things decide your badge — not one rating

A single unhappy review can't sink you. Your standing is a blend of four pillars:

- **Craft** — product quality: buyer ratings and a low defect / reprint rate.
- **Reliability** — accepting orders and delivering on time, with few strikes.
- **Contribution** — your footprint: completed orders and live products. A high-volume shop isn't punished for the occasional off-day.
- **Standing** — tenure and a clean recent record; trust built over time.

Ratings are smoothed

Ratings use **Bayesian smoothing**: a new shop with a handful of reviews sits near the platform average until it builds a real track record. One early 1-star doesn't define you, and a shop with 200 happy orders isn't judged the same as one with two.

Rate-based, so scale never counts against you

Quality signals are measured as **rates** (per 100 orders), not raw counts. Ten issues across 5,000 orders reads as excellent; ten across fifty does not. The more you produce, the more a stray problem is absorbed — volume protects you, it doesn't expose you.

The badges and what they unlock

- **Verified** — the starting line. Standard platform fee.
- **Trusted** — proven volume and quality over time. A reduced fee.
- **Premier** — top standing. The lowest fee tier — orders at zero platform fee.

Standing moves slowly and fairly — no whiplash

Promotions require your standing to *hold* for a sustained window, not spike for a day. Drops are gradual — a single rough stretch won't knock you down a rung overnight, and new shops get a grace period while they find their feet. The goal is a fair, stable signal, not a rollercoaster.

A rating you think is wrong? Contest it

If a review is unfair, mistaken, or was really about another partner's part of the job (a printer, packer, or warehouse), open an **appeal** from the "Recent ratings" list. An admin reviews every appeal. Three outcomes are possible:

- **Upheld** — the rating stands (with a reason).
- **Removed** — it's excluded from your score entirely.
- **Re-attributed** — it's moved to the partner it was actually about.

While your appeal is open, your standing is frozen

Filing is always safe: **your standing is frozen against demotion while an appeal is open**, so you're never worse off for raising a concern.

Nothing here labels you 'bad'

The system only ever recognizes positive standing — there is no negative stamp. Compliance and safety issues are handled separately and directly, never through your public badge.